

N13 LOCAL FOOD ENVIRONMENT | O (MAX : 1 PT)

Intent : Increase access to fresh, local and seasonal fruits and vegetables by reducing environmental barriers.

Summary : This WELL feature requires projects to take into consideration the local food environment during site selection or programming.

Issue : Dietary patterns around the world are influenced by a complex mixture of personal, cultural and environmental factors, including the local food environment. The local food environment encompasses the type and density of food retail outlets, including grocery stores and food service outlets, and the consistent availability of healthy, wholesome foods at these venues. However, certain environments have the potential to be more obesogenic than others, promoting weight gain and possibly contributing to obesity.¹ In particular, the presence of smaller grocery stores and fast food establishments influence food choices and is associated with a higher prevalence of obesity.²

Solutions :

Locating projects within close proximity to supermarkets, grocery stores and farmers markets can help individuals improve their dietary and lifestyle behaviors, through environments that support better food choices.^{2,3} Hospitals and healthcare institutions that host farmers' markets and farm stands contribute to healthier nutrition environments by positively impacting fruit and vegetable consumption, an effective model that may be generalizable to other large institutions.^{4,5} Beyond farmers' markets, increased healthy food retail outlet density is associated with a lower BMI, while supermarket availability is associated with meeting dietary recommendations.⁶⁻⁹ Mobile food markets, food carts and fruit and vegetable stands are additional ways to increase access to fruits and vegetables in the environments where individuals live, work and learn.⁴

PART 1 ENSURE LOCAL FOOD ACCESS (MAX : 1 PT)

For All Spaces:

Option 1: Supportive environment

The main building entrance is located within a 400 m walk distance of one of the following:

- Supermarket or store with a fresh fruit and vegetable section.¹⁰
- Farmers' market that is open at least once a week and operates for at least four months of the year.¹¹

OR

Option 2: Supportive programming

The project meets one of the following requirements:

- Serves as a distribution point for a community-based agriculture program that delivers fruits and vegetables at least twice a month for at least four months of the year, in which regular occupants can participate.¹¹
- Hosts the weekly sale of fruits and vegetables (e.g., fruit and vegetable carts or stands, mobile markets) for at least four months of the year.¹²

OR

Option 3: Supportive transportation

The project meets the following requirement:

- Transportation is provided at no cost between the project and a supermarket and/or store with a fresh fruit and vegetable section and/or farmers market.

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